2.0

CITY BUDGET 2025–26

A fiscally responsible budget with a sustainable long-term financial outlook including financial and policy documents.

Beach restoration post-Cyclone Alfred

2.1 City Budget 2025-26 Overview

Total budget for 2025-26

The 2025-26 Budget has been developed in alignment with the Council Plan 2022-2027, Annual Operational Plan and the Long-Term Financial Plan.

It continues to deliver high standard, value-for-money services to the community and provides funding for projects and programs that will improve the city transport network, deliver new community and cultural assets, and continue to protect and enhance our lifestyle.

The total budget for 2025-26 is $2,678 million, made up as follows:

- capital expenditure $1,069 million
- services and operating costs $1,509 million
- debt repayments $100 million.

Key initiatives for 2025-26

The following key initiatives are included in the budget:

Buildings	
Home of the Arts (HOTA), Evandale, Outdoor Stage	$15.0 million
City owned critical infrastructure and places of refuge	$10.8 million
HOTA, Evandale, asset renewal	$10.2 million
Design and construction of new Men's Shed at Oxenford Park, Oxenford	$1.2 million

Community Health and Safety	
Expanding and upgrading the Safety Camera Network	$1.7 million

Conservation and Environment	
Renewal of southern training wall at the entrance of Currumbin Creek, Currumbin	$5.9 million
Enhancement of car parking adjacent to the boat ramp at Ray Street, Runaway Bay	$0.4 million

Parks and Natural Areas	
Parks strategic land acquisitions	$25.0 million
Kerkin Road Adventure Parklands, Coomera	$14.2 million
Masterplan implementation at Pizzey Park, Miami	$7.5 million
Planning and design for future stages of Greenheart, Robina	$4.0 million

Plant and Equipment	
Light commercial vehicle purchases	$5.2 million
Heavy fleet (truck) renewal purchases	$4.6 million
Large street sweeper	$0.5 million

Sport and Recreation Facilities	
Firth Park, Mudgeeraba netball upgrade	$14.9 million
Female and accessible facilities across the city	$10.0 million
AFL field at Coomera Sports Park, Coomera	$7.0 million

Strategic Initiatives	
Advanced Resource Recovery Centre	$120.6 million
Strategic land fund	$15.0 million
Koala habitat land acquisition	$10.0 million
Repurpose the Surfers Paradise Transit Centre into the Gold Coast Civic and Music Hall	$8.5 million

Transport	
Road rehabilitation and reseal program, including kerb and channel replacement	$95.9 million
Road upgrade at Burnside Road, Stapylton	$25.0 million
Road upgrade at Peachey Road, Ormeau	$15.0 million
Renewal works at Bruce Bishop carpark, Surfers Paradise	$15.0 million
Road upgrade at Goldmine Road, Ormeau	$12.6 million
Road upgrade at George Alexander Way, Coomera	$11.0 million
Bridge replacement over Lake Heron on Cassowary Drive, Burleigh Waters	$10.0 million
Southern Gold Coast Highway - Underground Services model	$10.0 million
Road upgrade at Yawalpah Road, Pimpama	$9.6 million
Bridge construction on Yawalpah Road, Pimpama	$8.6 million
Safety improvements and lighting across the city	$7.6 million
Car park upgrade at Doug Jennings park, Main Beach	$7.2 million
Shared path construction on Foxwell Road, Coomera	$7.2 million
Subsidising bus services in the northern Gold Coast to improve accessibility	$1.7 million

Waste	
Pimpama Premium Waste and Recycling Centre stage 2	$18.0 million
Stapylton landfill sediment basin	$13.2 million
Green organics pad at Molendinar waste and recycling centre	$7.6 million
Renewal works at waste and recycling centres across the city	$5.3 million
Relocation of the green organics pad from the Merrimac waste and recycling centre to the adjoining koala fodder plantation site	$5.2 million

Water and Sewerage	
Pimpama sewage treatment plant stage 2 upgrade	$65.0 million
Stapylton sewerage network upgrade	$30.0 million
Elanora sewage treatment plant upgrade works	$24.0 million
Water and sewerage works at the Coomera Connector project from Coomera to Nerang	$20.0 million
Renewal of water reservoir components across the city	$12.7 million
Renewal of water main components across the city	$12.7 million
Renewal of eastern and western force mains components across the city	$12.0 million
Merrimac sewage treatment plant stage 6 upgrade	$9.0 million
Renewal of sewage treatment plant switchboards across the city	$9.0 million
Gravity trunk sewer at Christensen Road South, Stapylton	$9.0 million
Renewal of sewer non-pressure mains across the city	$8.8 million
Renewal of water meters across the city	$7.2 million
Renewal of Elanora sewage treatment plant digesters	$7.0 million
Trunk sewerage infrastructure at Burnside Road, Stapylton	$6.8 million
Recycled water network expansion stage 2	$6.5 million
Renewal of sewer pressure mains across the city	$5.3 million

Debt management

Total debt is expected to increase by $288 million in 2025-26 (from $810 million in June 2025 to $1,098 million in June 2026), accounting for principal repayments of $65 million and new borrowings of $353 million.

The City is well within industry benchmarks used to measure debt and its impact on financial sustainability. The leverage ratio (debt divided by operating surplus plus depreciation and finance costs) forecast for 2025-26 is 2.3 times which is comfortably in the target range of 0-4 times for tier 2 Councils (major cities with a population of 100,000 – 999,999) and comfortably remains so for the entirety of the 10-year financial forecast.

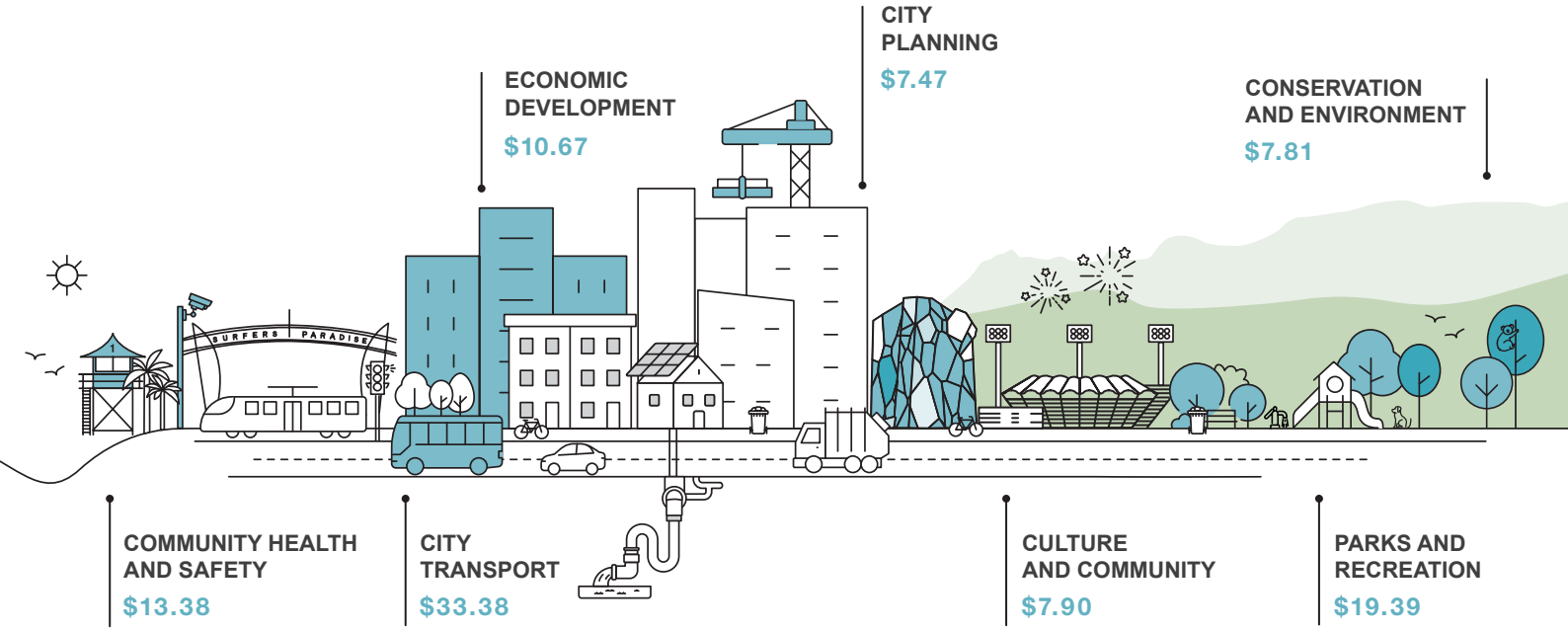
The financial sustainability targets are issued by the Queensland Government, Department of Housing, Local Government, Planning and Public Works.

What this budget means for you

For every $100 – where your rates go.

Rates

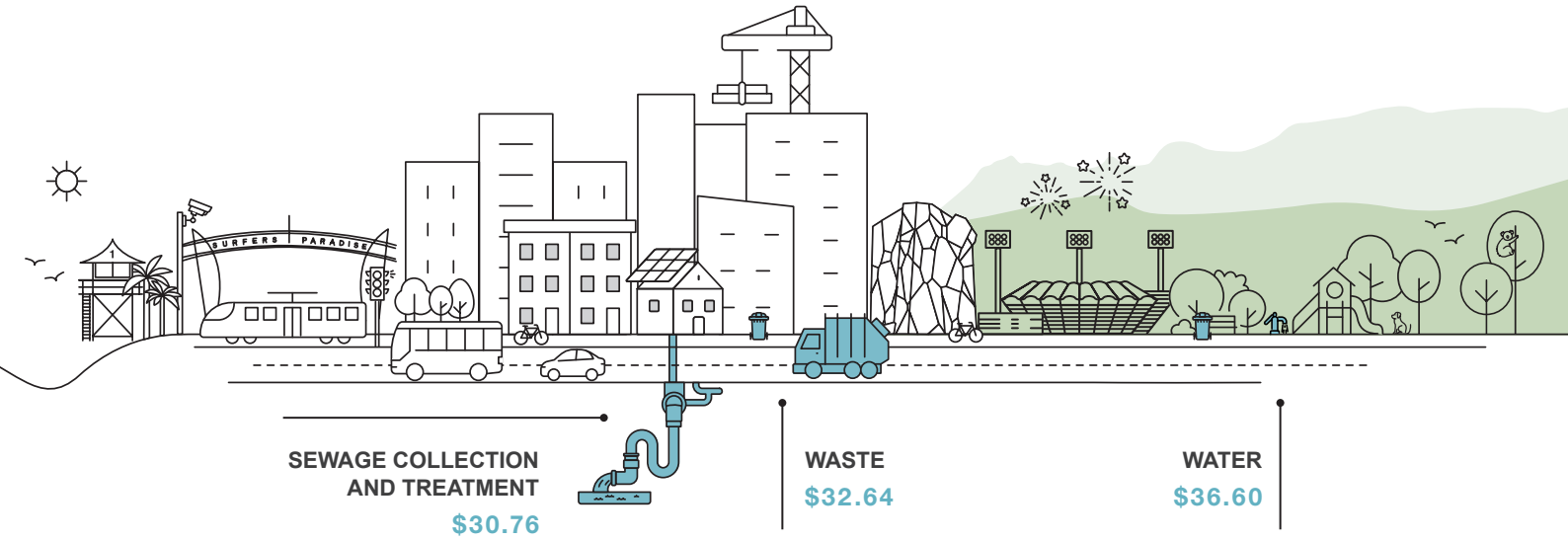
Council invests your rates back into our community. Every $100 of rates is invested in the following city services and infrastructure.



For every $100 – where your rates go.

Utilities

Council invests your utility charges back into our community. Every $100 is invested in the following utility services and infrastructure.



2.2 Revenue and Expenditure (including rates and charges)

Revenue 2025-26

Council's primary revenue sources are made up of the following revenue items.

Table 1: Revenue 2025-26

	2024-25 ($ million)	2025-26 ($ million)
Net Rates and Utility Charges	1,559.0	1,659.0
Fees & Charges	160.7	181.1
Interest Revenue	47.6	41.1
Other Revenue	38.1	55.1
Operating Contributions and Donations	2.4	2.2
Operating Grants and Subsidies	25.8	38.2
Total Capital Income	200.2	198.3
Total	**2,033.8**	**2,175.1**

For details on rates and charges refer to Table 5.

Expenditure programs 2025-26

The following table provides a breakdown of the major expenditure programs to be undertaken by the City as part of the 2025-26 budget. The City's expenditure programs are guided by the priorities identified in the Council Plan 2022-2027 and feedback received through community consultation. We are focused on creating more connected communities; improving our sporting facilities; and preserving and protecting our precious green and open spaces.

Compared to 2024-25, the City's total budget has increased by $215 million.

Key capital projects included in the 2025-26 budget are identified in section 2.1 of this report.

Table 2: Expenditure by program

	2024-25 ($ million)	2025-26 ($ million)
Program 1: City Planning	68.5	90.9
Program 2: City Transport	438.1	406.5
Program 3: Community Health and Safety	150.3	163.0
Program 4: Conservation and Environment	99.7	95.0
Program 5: Culture and Community	86.1	96.2
Program 6: Economic Development	145.8	130.0
Program 7: Enabling Services	506.0	490.6
Program 8: Parks and Recreation	224.0	236.1
Program 9: Waste Management	197.2	316.5
Program 10: Water and Sewerage	547.2	653.2
Total	**2,462.9**	**2,678.0**

2.3 Long-term financial forecast

Financial goals and strategies

In preparing the long-term financial forecast the City has sought to:

- deliver the key outcomes of the Council Plan 2022-2027 and implement the themes and aspirations of Gold Coast 2032
- maintain rate increases at or below CPI for a residential property that is a non-Community Title Property principal place of residence with a median rateable valuation
- prudently manage debt
- continue to deliver value for money services to the community
- fully fund asset renewal requirements to maintain infrastructure assets
- reduce congestion on roads
- provide funding for community and sporting facilities
- fund key initiatives included in the City's key strategies.

Financial decisions are guided by corporate policies, strategies and principles of effective financial management. The City regularly models financial performance, financial position and cash flow forecasts to monitor the long-term sustainability of decisions. The long-term financial outlook is updated quarterly, and a comprehensive analysis is undertaken between July and December each year, and this sets the context for the development of the annual budget. Projected financial statements are presented later in this chapter in sections 2.6 to 2.10.

2.4 Financial Performance

The City's financial performance can be evaluated against four key pillars:

1. competitive rating levels and user pays charges
2. debt levels and capacity to service debt
3. the condition of City infrastructure assets
4. the scope and standard of services.

In terms of financial performance and sustainability, the City continues to perform well against these four pillars.

Competitive rating levels and user pay charges

The City's rates and utility charges remain competitive with other South-East Queensland Councils, particularly considering comparative levels of service.

The City applies the principles of equity and fairness, equity for like properties, user pays, meaningful contribution and predictability in setting rates and utility charges as set out in the Revenue Policy.

The City's Revenue Policy is presented later in this chapter in section 2.16.

Debt levels and capacity to service debt

The City is focused on responsibly managing debt in the short and long-term. Debt is used to fund capital expenditure and investment initiatives. It is generally borrowed over the maximum allowable term by Queensland Treasury Corporation (QTC) of 20 years.

The City will remain well within debt servicing capacity ratio benchmarks set by the State Government and QTC as shown in the ratio tables in section 2.5. The leverage ratio (debt divided by operating surplus plus depreciation and finance costs) forecast for 2025-26 is 2.3 times which is comfortably in the target range of 0-4 times for tier 2 councils.

The level of borrowings drawn each financial year is carefully monitored through long-term financial modelling to ensure affordability. In addition to internal assessments, the City is required to submit an annual application to the State Government, which includes the long-term financial forecast, to gain approval for all planned borrowings.

QTC undertakes a detailed annual credit assessment of the City and makes recommendations to the State Government regarding sustainable borrowing levels. In March 2025, the City's credit rating was reaffirmed as Strong with a Neutral outlook.

The City's Debt Policy is presented later in this chapter in section 2.17.

State of the City's asset management

Effective asset management helps the City deliver quality services and meet its long-term goals. It ensures better infrastructure performance, data-driven planning and budgeting, reduced risk, and long-term sustainability.

In 2024, the City completed an asset management maturity assessment, identifying key areas for improvement including the development of a Strategic Asset Management Plan, upgrading asset management systems, improving processes to ensure consistency and effectiveness, risk reporting and a greater focus on critical assets. To address these key areas, the City launched the Asset Excellence Program to uplift asset management capability.

The City manages over 2 million assets with a replacement value of $31.8 billion. Figure 1 displays the condition of all assets over the past five years. Figure 2 displays the current condition of assets by network. Continued growth across the City highlights the need for continued and increased investment to maintain service levels and reduce the risk of asset failure.

Figure 1: Condition trend of City infrastructure assets

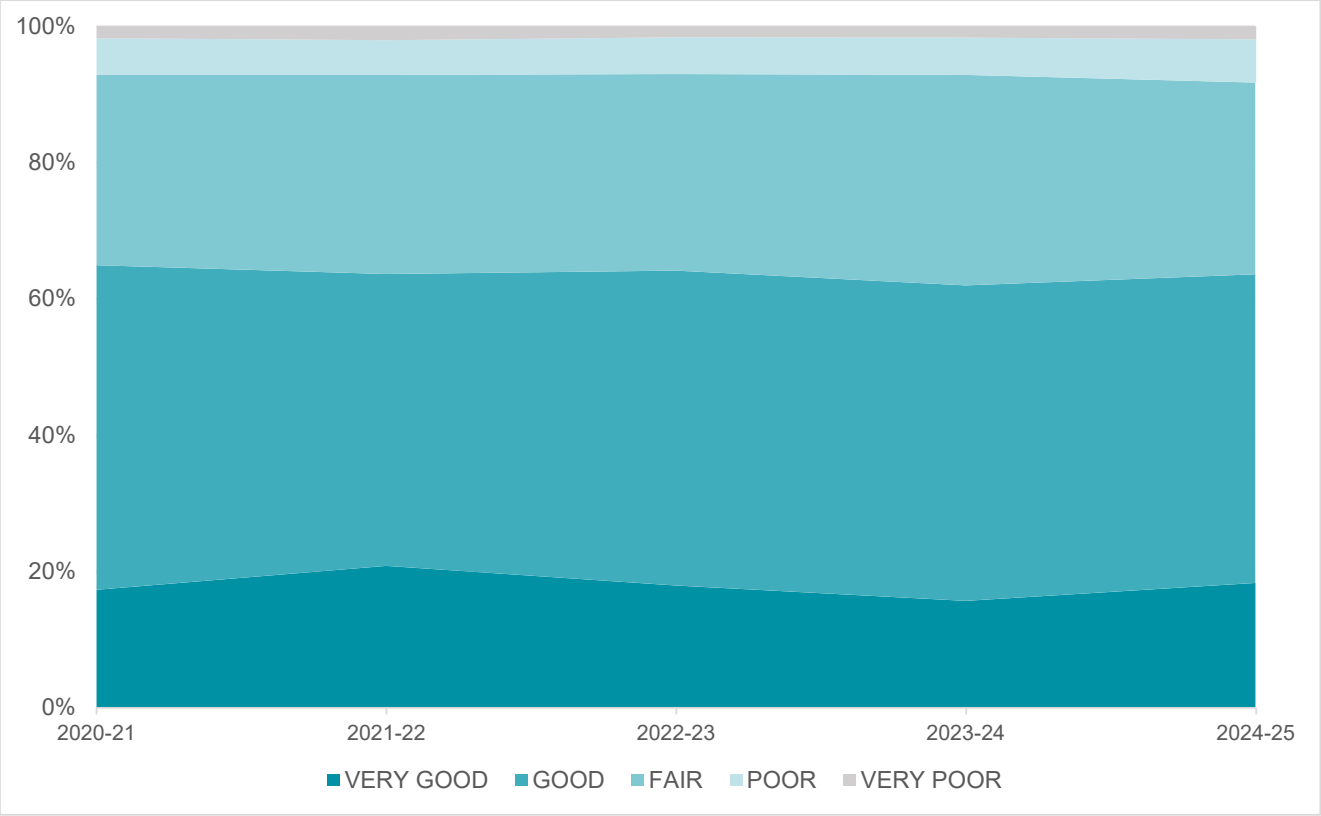
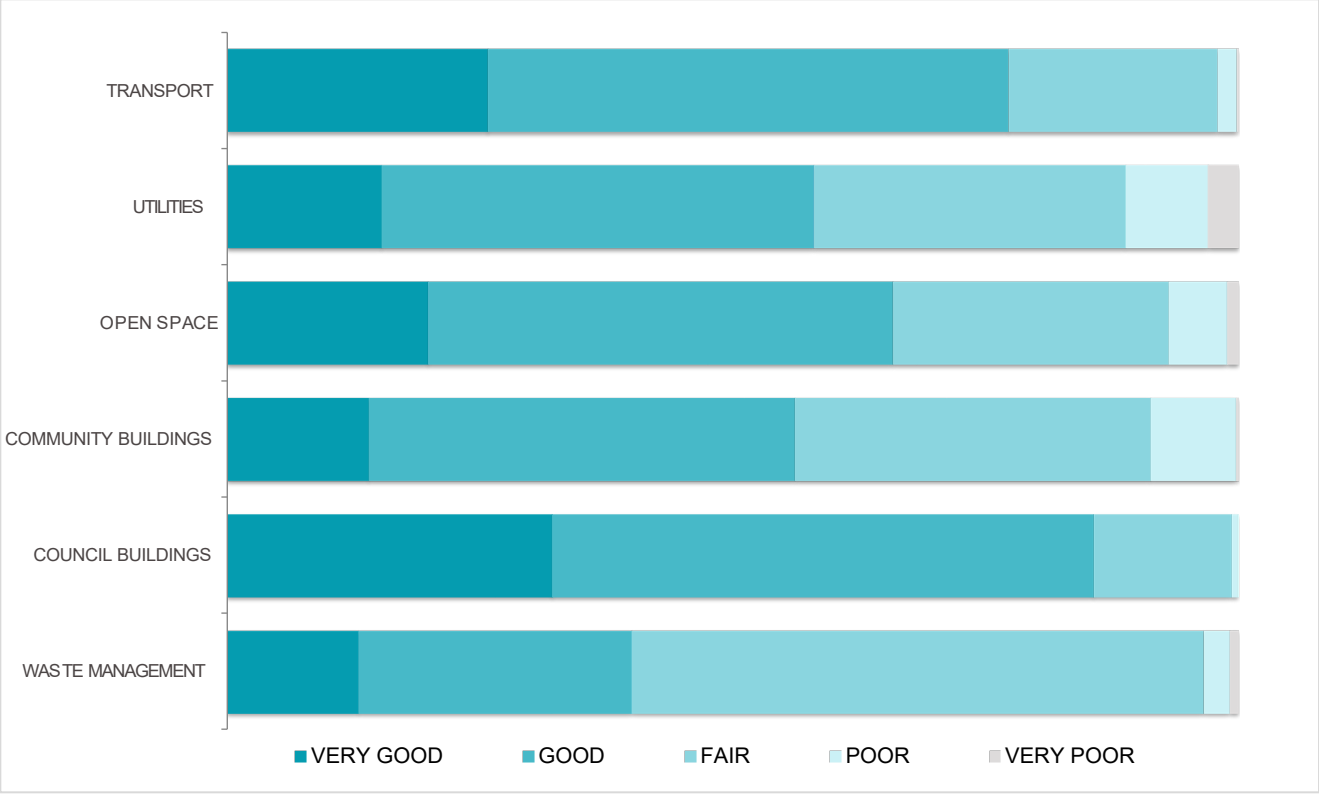


Figure 2: Overall condition of City infrastructure assets



Maintaining and renewing infrastructure is vital for long-term sustainability. The Asset Sustainability Ratio (ASR) is a metric used by all Councils to track if current and future renewal funding is keeping pace with asset deterioration. The State Government recommends a minimum ASR of 60% over five years for a council the size of the City of Gold Coast. Ongoing investment is key to meeting this target.

Looking ahead, the City will continue to review and adjust renewal plans based on updated condition data and service risk profiles through its annual planning and budgeting cycles.

2.5 Financial sustainability measures

Financial Sustainability reporting is prescribed by the *Local Government Regulation 2012* (the Regulation) and the Financial Management (Sustainability) Guideline 2024 (the Guideline).

The measures are designed to indicate the financial health of the City across the ten-year reporting period. Under the Guideline, the City is classified as a tier 2 Council (population 100,000 to 999,999) with targets specific to tier 2. The Guideline states that Local governments are required to calculate and publish the relevant sustainability measures on both a council and consolidated basis. Council remains within the target range for the forecast period as shown in Tables 3 and 4 below.

Table 3: Financial Sustainability Ratios (Council)

Type	Measure	Target (Tier 2)	Forecast 30 June 2026	Forecast 30 June 2027	Forecast 30 June 2028	Forecast 30 June 2029	Forecast 30 June 2030	Forecast 30 June 2031	Forecast 30 June 2032	Forecast 30June 2033	Forecast 30 June 2034	Forecast 30 June 2035
Financial Capacity	Council-Controlled Revenue	N/A	93.2%	95.5%	96.2%	96.2%	96.3%	96.2%	93.8%	88.4%	88.4%	88.5%
	Population Growth	N/A	3.3%	2.5%	2.5%	2.5%	2.5%	2.5%	2.3%	2.3%	2.3%	2.3%
Operating Performance	Operating Surplus Ratio	Greater than 0%	1.1%	4.2%	5.3%	5.2%	4.8%	0.2%	3.0%	9.9%	9.5%	9.1%
	Operating Cash Ratio	Greater than 0%	23.6%	28.2%	29.1%	29.2%	28.7%	24.9%	27.2%	32.7%	32.0%	31.2%
Liquidity	Unrestricted Cash Expense Cover Ratio	Greater than 2 months	N/A for Long-Term Sustainability Statement									
Asset Management	Asset Sustainability Ratio	Greater than 60%	100.5%	104.0%	90.6%	74.0%	73.1%	70.6%	63.9%	62.1%	60.8%	56.1%
	Asset Consumption Ratio	Greater than 60%	70.0%	69.5%	69.1%	68.5%	68.3%	67.6%	67.0%	66.5%	65.9%	65.3%
	Asset Renewal Funding Ratio	N/A	N/A for Long-Term Sustainability Statement									
Debt Servicing Capacity	Leverage Ratio	0 to 4 times	2.3 times	2.1 times	2.3 times	2.5 times	3.1 times	3.9 times	3.5 times	2.6 times	2.6 times	2.6 times

Table 4: Financial Sustainability Ratios (Consolidated)

Type	Measure	Target (Tier 2)	Forecast 30 June 2026	Forecast 30 June 2027	Forecast 30 June 2028	Forecast 30 June 2029	Forecast 30 June 2030	Forecast 30 June 2031	Forecast 30 June 2032	Forecast 30June 2033	Forecast 30 June 2034	Forecast 30 June 2035
Financial Capacity	Council-Controlled Revenue	N/A	93.2%	95.5%	96.2%	96.2%	96.3%	96.2%	93.8%	88.4%	88.4%	88.5%
	Population Growth	N/A	3.3%	2.5%	2.5%	2.5%	2.5%	2.5%	2.3%	2.3%	2.3%	2.3%
Operating Performance	Operating Surplus Ratio	Greater than 0%	0.9%	3.8%	5.0%	4.9%	4.5%	0.2%	2.8%	9.5%	9.1%	8.7%
	Operating Cash Ratio	Greater than 0%	22.3%	26.7%	27.6%	27.7%	27.3%	23.7%	25.9%	31.3%	30.6%	29.9%
Liquidity	Unrestricted Cash Expense Cover Ratio	Greater than 2 months	N/A for Long-Term Sustainability Statement									
Asset Management	Asset Sustainability Ratio	Greater than 60%	100.5%	104.0%	90.6%	74.0%	73.1%	70.6%	63.9%	62.1%	60.8%	56.1%
	Asset Consumption Ratio	Greater than 60%	70.0%	69.5%	69.1%	68.5%	68.3%	67.6%	67.0%	66.5%	65.9%	65.3%
	Asset Renewal Funding Ratio	N/A	N/A for Long-Term Sustainability Statement									
Debt Servicing Capacity	Leverage Ratio	0 to 4 times	2.3 times	2.1 times	2.3 times	2.5 times	3.1 times	3.9 times	3.5 times	2.6 times	2.6 times	2.6 times

2.6 Statement of Estimated Financial Position 2024-25

In accordance with Section 205 of the Regulation, the following statement serves to inform the budget adoption meeting of the City of Gold Coast's (the City's) financial operations and estimated financial position for 2024-25. A detailed schedule showing the estimated position as at 30 June 2025 is provided on the following pages.

Special Purpose Financial Statement (Unaudited)
Forecast Statement of Income and Expenditure for City Of Gold Coast
For The Period Ended 30 June 2025

	Gold Coast Water ($'000)	Tourist Parks ($'000)	Waste Management ($'000)	Other Activities ($'000)	TOTAL ($'000)
Revenue					
Rates & Utility Charges	619,136	0	124,099	891,987	1,635,222
Rates Discounts & Remissions	0	0	0	(75,732)	(75,732)
Fees And Charges	7,065	28,170	24,738	106,478	166,451
Interest Revenue	17,029	0	4,335	27,725	49,090
Gain/Loss On Sale Of Assets	(5,000)	0	7,750	(8,353)	(5,603)
Contribution & Donations Revenue	60,000	0	0	119,280	179,280
Grants & Subsidies Revenue	1,206	0	1,254	81,962	84,422
Other Revenue	2,056	133	1,600	38,550	42,339
Total Revenue	**701,492**	**28,303**	**163,777**	**1,181,896**	**2,075,469**
Expenses					
Employee Costs	63,218	516	6,214	536,451	606,400
Materials And Services	658,703	27,509	161,007	875,149	1,722,369
Depreciation & Amortisation	144,824	1,160	6,320	222,696	375,000
Finance Costs	0	0	0	19,503	19,503
Other Expenses	3,991	796	15,397	102,358	122,543
Capitalised Expenses	(191,221)	(5,253)	(40,228)	(724,876)	(961,577)
Total Expenses	**679,516**	**24,729**	**148,710**	**1,031,282**	**1,884,238**
Net Result	**21,976**	**3,575**	**15,066**	**150,614**	**191,231**

Special Purpose Financial Statement (Unaudited)
Forecast Statement of Financial Position For City Of Gold Coast as at 30 June 2025

	2025 Estimated Balance ($'000)
Assets	
Current Assets	
Cash Assets	710,000
Current Receivables	289,786
Inventories	27,242
Prepayments	13,380
Clearing Accounts	0
	1,040,408
Non Current Assets	
Other Financial Assets	1,150
Property, Plant And Equipment	21,685,294
Assets Under Construction	0
	21,686,444
Total Assets	**22,726,852**
Liabilities	
Current Liabilities	
Current Payables	(152,045)
Unearned Revenue	(108,220)
Current Employee Benefits	(39,621)
Current Borrowings	(67,403)
Clearing Accounts	0
	(367,289)
Non Current Liabilities	
Non Current Employee Benefits	(68,509)
Non Current Provisions	(59,915)
Non Current Lease Liabilities	(16,871)
Non Current Borrowings	(742,320)
	(887,615)
Total Liabilities	**(1,254,904)**
Net Community Assets	**21,471,948**
Community Equity	
Retained Capital	10,581,317
Reserves	10,890,631
Total Community Equity	**21,471,948**

2.7 Accrual Budget and Statement of Income and Expenditure 2025-26 to 2034-35

Accrual Budget and Statement of Income and Expenditure for 2025-26						
	Note	Gold Coast Water Initial Budget ($'000)	Tourist Parks Initial Budget ($'000)	Waste Management Initial Budget ($'000)	Other Activities Initial Budget ($'000)	TOTAL Initial Budget ($'000)
REVENUE FROM ORDINARY ACTIVITIES						
Operating Income						
Rates and Utility Charges	1	653,467	0	155,867	928,297	1,737,632
Less: Discounts and Pensioner Remissions		0	0	0	(78,629)	(78,629)
		653,467	**0**	**155,867**	**849,668**	**1,659,003**
Fees & Charges	2	7,627	29,051	27,630	116,790	181,098
Interest	3	17,029	0	4,335	19,750	41,115
Other Revenue	4	1,797	133	1,600	51,591	55,121
Community Service Obligations		0	1,800	3,311	(5,111)	0
		26,453	**30,984**	**36,876**	**183,020**	**277,333**
Contributions and Donations	5	0	0	0	2,249	2,249
Operating Grants and Subsidies	6	0	0	34	38,206	38,240
		0	**0**	**34**	**40,455**	**40,489**
Total Operating Income		**679,921**	**30,984**	**192,777**	**1,073,143**	**1,976,826**
Capital Income						
Contributions from Developers (Cash)		41,000	0	0	62,500	103,500
Contributions from Developers (Non Cash)		19,000	0	0	53,925	72,925
Other Capital Revenue	7	435	0	0	17,316	17,751
Profit / (Loss) on Sale of Assets	8	(5,000)	0	0	9,136	4,136
Total Capital Income		**55,435**	**0**	**0**	**142,876**	**198,311**
Total Revenue from Ordinary Activities		**735,356**	**30,984**	**192,777**	**1,216,020**	**2,175,137**
EXPENSES FROM ORDINARY ACTIVITIES						
Employee Costs (including statutory oncosts)		65,147	395	9,200	599,538	674,281
Materials & Services (incl internal transactions)		422,833	27,843	173,391	865,972	1,490,039
Depreciation and Amortisation		144,824	1,160	6,320	258,821	411,125
Finance Costs	9	698	141	2,113	35,204	38,155
Other Expenses	10	242,615	794	20,522	146,794	410,725
(Capitalised Expenses)		(319,291)	(10,048)	(70,213)	(669,839)	(1,069,391)
Total Expenses from Ordinary Activities		**556,825**	**20,286**	**141,333**	**1,236,490**	**1,954,934**
Income Tax Equivalents		52,594	3,673	19,940	(76,208)	0
Dividends and Returns		88,824	3,140	0	(91,964)	0
NET RESULT FOR THE YEAR		**37,113**	**3,885**	**31,504**	**147,702**	**220,204**
CAPITAL TRANSACTIONS						
Sources of Capital Funding						
Net Result		37,113	3,885	31,504	147,702	220,204
Depreciation		144,824	1,160	6,320	258,821	411,125
Loans		42,981	0	40,996	269,392	353,368
Book Value of Assets Traded / Disposed		5,000	0	0	13,800	18,800
Transfers to Reserves		0	(4,204)	(21,886)	(125,404)	(151,493)
Transfers from Reserves		31,971	10,048	22,610	116,597	181,226
Transfers to Infrastructure Charges Reserve		(41,000)	0	0	(62,500)	(103,500)
Trsfrs From Infrastructure Charges Reserve		123,124	0	0	154,305	277,429
Total Sources of Capital Funding		**344,013**	**10,889**	**79,544**	**772,713**	**1,207,158**
Allocations of Capital Funding						
Constructed and Purchased Assets		319,291	10,048	70,213	669,839	1,069,391
Loan Redemption		5,721	841	9,331	48,950	64,843
Contributed Assets		19,000	0	0	53,925	72,925
Total Capital Allocations		**344,013**	**10,889**	**79,544**	**772,713**	**1,207,158**
Budget Surplus / (Deficit)		**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**

Accrual Budget and Statement of Income and Expenditure for 2025-26

Notes to Accrual Budget and Statement of Income and Expenditure

	($'000)
1 Rates and Utility Charges (Gross Levies)	
General Rates (Incl. Differential Rates)	831,302
Water Rates	394,652
Sewerage	258,816
Waste Service	155,867
Transport Separate Charge	66,424
Other Separate Rates	30,571
	1,737,632
2 Fees & Charges	
Building And Development Fees	33,620
Cemetery Fees	2,828
Infringements	32,040
Licenses And Permits	6,175
Other Fees And Charges	17,677
Parking Fees	16,696
Private Works	444
Property And Information Fees	7,676
Waste Management	27,630
Tourist Park Fees	29,051
Water And Wastewater	7,261
	181,098
3 Interest Revenue	
Interest on Rate Arrears	8,490
Interest Other	32,625
	41,115
4 Other Revenue	
Rental & Lease Revenue	33,976
Canteen Revenue	4,754
Insurance Claim Recovery	2,390
Dividend	4,000
Commission Income	1,067
Sundry Revenue	8,933
	55,121
5 Contributions and Donations	
City Cleaning - Department of Transport and Main Roads	1,794
Ex-Gratia Contribution	380
Mayor's Christmas Carols	50
SES Operations	26
	2,249

	($'000)
6 Operating Grants and Subsidies	
Financial Assistance Grant	18,648
Tropical Cyclone Alfred Recovery	15,000
Library Resources	2,834
Grants & Subsidies - Other	1,758
	38,240
7 Capital Grants & Subsidies	
Federal Grants and Subsidies	13,319
State Grants & Subsidies	4,217
Other Capital Revenue	215
	17,751
8 Profit / (Loss) on Sale of Assets	
Proceeds From Sale	22,936
Less : Disposal Costs and Retired Book Value	(18,800)
	4,136
9 Finance Costs	
Bank Fees and Finance Charges	2,657
QTC Book Debt Finance Charges	35,499
	38,155
10 Other Expenses	
Bulk Water Purchases	238,611
Contributions	111,323
Waste Levy Payment	39,801
Waste Levy Rebate	(20,990)
Insurance	13,561
Other	28,418
	410,725

Accrual Budget and Statement of Income and Expenditure 2025-26 to 2034-35

	2025-26 Budget ($'000)	2026-27 Forecast ($'000)	2027-28 Forecast ($'000)	2028-29 Forecast ($'000)	2029-30 Forecast ($'000)	2030-31 Forecast ($'000)	2031-32 Forecast ($'000)	2032-33 Forecast ($'000)	2033-34 Forecast ($'000)	2034-35 Forecast ($'000)
OPERATING INCOME										
Rates and Utility Charges	1,737,632	1,854,620	1,967,469	2,068,626	2,171,715	2,259,189	2,350,194	2,444,871	2,543,373	2,645,860
Less : Discounts & Pensioner Remissions	(78,629)	(80,988)	(83,417)	(85,920)	(88,497)	(91,152)	(93,887)	(96,703)	(99,604)	(102,593)
Net Rates	1,659,003	1,773,632	1,884,052	1,982,706	2,083,217	2,168,037	2,256,307	2,348,168	2,443,769	2,543,268
Fees & Charges	181,098	193,047	203,372	213,532	220,062	231,289	240,751	250,601	260,856	271,532
Interest	41,115	15,137	5,272	6,555	4,993	8,967	11,824	13,813	13,871	15,450
Other Revenue	55,121	52,360	53,488	55,616	57,828	60,129	127,721	302,809	316,196	324,886
	277,333	260,544	262,132	275,703	282,883	300,385	380,296	567,223	590,922	611,867
Contributions & Donations	2,249	2,272	2,294	2,317	2,341	2,364	2,388	2,412	2,436	2,460
Operating Grants & Subsidies	38,240	22,155	22,377	22,600	22,826	23,055	23,285	23,518	23,753	23,991
	40,489	24,427	24,671	24,918	25,167	25,419	25,673	25,930	26,189	26,451
Total Operating Income	**1,976,826**	**2,058,603**	**2,170,855**	**2,283,327**	**2,391,267**	**2,493,840**	**2,662,276**	**2,941,320**	**3,060,880**	**3,181,586**
Capital Income										
Contributions from Developers (Cash)	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500
Contributions from Developers (Non-cash)	72,925	87,291	88,998	90,748	92,542	94,380	96,265	98,196	100,176	102,205
Capital Grants & Subsidies	17,751	18,517	15,918	16,395	16,887	17,394	17,916	18,454	19,007	19,577
Profit / (Loss) on Sale of Assets	4,136	5,313	11,101	13,771	11,921	10,139	15,220	8,968	9,649	9,649
Total Capital Income	**198,311**	**214,620**	**219,517**	**224,413**	**224,849**	**225,413**	**232,901**	**229,118**	**232,332**	**234,932**
Total Revenue from Ordinary Activities	**2,175,137**	**2,273,223**	**2,390,372**	**2,507,740**	**2,616,117**	**2,719,254**	**2,895,177**	**3,170,438**	**3,293,212**	**3,416,518**
EXPENSES FROM ORDINARY ACTIVITIES										
Employee Costs, Materials & Services	1,505,654	1,478,943	1,538,552	1,616,843	1,703,943	1,872,038	1,937,792	1,980,368	2,082,307	2,187,706
Depreciation & Amortisation	411,125	443,536	460,700	478,370	491,848	515,312	531,392	547,948	565,490	581,488
Borrowing Costs	38,155	50,527	55,549	68,534	79,516	101,037	114,063	120,756	121,536	122,633
Total Expenses from Ordinary Activities	**1,954,934**	**1,973,006**	**2,054,801**	**2,163,747**	**2,275,306**	**2,488,387**	**2,583,247**	**2,649,071**	**2,769,333**	**2,891,827**
NET RESULT FOR THE YEAR	**220,204**	**300,217**	**335,571**	**343,994**	**340,810**	**230,867**	**311,929**	**521,367**	**523,879**	**524,691**
Sources of Capital Funding										
Depreciation	411,125	443,536	460,700	478,370	491,848	515,312	531,392	547,948	565,490	581,488
Loans	353,368	168,265	340,781	310,885	527,911	357,428	237,920	125,520	140,998	144,565
Book Value of assets traded / disposed	18,800	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Transfers To Reserves	(151,493)	(190,503)	(203,143)	(215,952)	(181,254)	(198,636)	(187,134)	(197,924)	(194,060)	(264,163)
Transfers From Reserves	181,226	216,293	156,941	137,926	147,904	152,202	163,567	158,581	173,959	167,631
Trsfrs To Infrastructure Charges Reserve	(103,500)	(103,500)	(103,500)	(103,500)	(103,500)	(103,500)	(103,500)	(103,500)	(103,500)	(103,500)
Trsfrs From Infrastructure Charges Reserve	277,429	239,991	171,966	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500	103,500
Total Sources of Capital Funding	**1,207,158**	**1,074,299**	**1,159,317**	**1,055,223**	**1,327,219**	**1,057,173**	**1,057,675**	**1,155,492**	**1,210,267**	**1,154,213**
Allocations of Capital Funding										
Constructed and Purchased Assets	1,069,391	921,455	997,841	877,985	1,143,026	869,619	854,703	943,480	987,174	920,003
Loan Redemption	64,843	65,553	72,477	86,490	91,652	93,174	106,707	113,816	122,917	132,004
Contributed Assets	72,925	87,291	88,998	90,748	92,542	94,380	96,265	98,196	100,176	102,205
Total Capital Allocations	**1,207,158**	**1,074,299**	**1,159,317**	**1,055,223**	**1,327,219**	**1,057,173**	**1,057,675**	**1,155,492**	**1,210,267**	**1,154,213**
Budget Surplus / (Deficit)	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**	**0**

2.8 Statement of Financial Position 2025-26 to 2034-35

	2025-26 Initial Budget ($'000)	2026-27 Forecast ($'000)	2027-28 Forecast ($'000)	2028-29 Forecast ($'000)	2029-30 Forecast ($'000)	2030-31 Forecast ($'000)	2031-32 Forecast ($'000)	2032-33 Forecast ($'000)	2033-34 Forecast ($'000)	2034-35 Forecast ($'000)
CURRENT ASSETS										
Cash assets	493,959	308,168	272,409	340,785	365,729	414,425	418,030	416,545	428,225	516,777
Receivables	312,028	331,650	351,677	369,906	387,858	404,016	431,185	476,677	496,270	515,800
Inventories	40,129	40,129	40,129	40,129	40,129	40,129	40,129	40,129	40,129	40,129
Prepayments	13,380	13,380	13,380	13,380	13,380	13,380	13,380	13,380	13,380	13,380
TOTAL CURRENT ASSETS	859,496	693,327	677,595	764,200	807,095	871,951	902,723	946,732	978,004	1,086,086
NON-CURRENT ASSETS										
Receivables	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150	1,150
Property, plant and equipment	22,384,798	23,541,031	24,197,495	24,723,263	25,507,772	26,000,060	26,448,451	26,969,379	27,516,014	27,980,811
TOTAL NON-CURRENT ASSETS	22,385,948	23,542,181	24,198,645	24,724,413	25,508,922	26,001,210	26,449,601	26,970,529	27,517,164	27,981,961
TOTAL ASSETS	**23,245,444**	**24,235,508**	**24,876,240**	**25,488,613**	**26,316,018**	**26,873,161**	**27,352,324**	**27,917,260**	**28,495,167**	**29,068,047**
CURRENT LIABILITIES										
Payables	165,964	162,076	168,608	177,188	186,733	205,155	212,361	217,027	228,198	239,749
Unearned revenue	67,799	67,799	67,799	67,799	67,799	67,799	67,799	67,799	67,799	67,799
Provisions	96,294	96,294	96,294	96,294	96,294	96,294	96,294	96,294	96,294	96,294
Interest bearing loans	65,553	72,477	86,490	91,652	93,174	106,707	113,816	122,917	132,004	141,878
TOTAL CURRENT LIABILITIES	395,610	398,646	419,192	432,933	444,000	475,955	490,270	504,036	524,295	545,720
NON-CURRENT LIABILITIES										
Provisions	124,986	124,986	124,986	124,986	124,986	124,986	124,986	124,986	124,986	124,986
Interest bearing loans	1,032,696	1,128,484	1,382,774	1,602,007	2,036,745	2,287,466	2,411,570	2,414,173	2,423,167	2,425,854
TOTAL NON-CURRENT LIABILITIES	1,157,682	1,253,470	1,507,760	1,726,993	2,161,731	2,412,452	2,536,556	2,539,159	2,548,153	2,550,840
TOTAL LIABILITIES	**1,553,292**	**1,652,116**	**1,926,952**	**2,159,926**	**2,605,731**	**2,888,407**	**3,026,826**	**3,043,195**	**3,072,448**	**3,096,560**
NET COMMUNITY ASSETS	**21,692,151**	**22,583,392**	**22,949,288**	**23,328,687**	**23,710,287**	**23,984,754**	**24,325,498**	**24,874,065**	**25,422,719**	**25,971,487**
COMMUNITY EQUITY										
Retained capital	10,938,161	11,400,659	11,758,495	12,024,462	12,331,923	12,516,356	12,804,718	13,286,743	13,790,521	14,218,680
Reserves	10,753,990	11,182,734	11,190,794	11,304,225	11,378,364	11,468,398	11,520,780	11,587,323	11,632,198	11,752,807
TOTAL COMMUNITY EQUITY	**21,692,151**	**22,583,392**	**22,949,288**	**23,328,687**	**23,710,287**	**23,984,754**	**24,325,498**	**24,874,065**	**25,422,719**	**25,971,487**

2.9 Statement of Cash Flows 2025-26 to 2034-35

	2025-26 Initial Budget ($'000)	2026-27 Forecast ($'000)	2027-28 Forecast ($'000)	2028-29 Forecast ($'000)	2029-30 Forecast ($'000)	2030-31 Forecast ($'000)	2031-32 Forecast ($'000)	2032-33 Forecast ($'000)	2033-34 Forecast ($'000)	2034-35 Forecast ($'000)
CASH FLOWS FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES										
Receipts	2,081,948	2,160,997	2,270,246	2,384,993	2,493,703	2,598,576	2,756,524	3,017,781	3,163,795	3,285,133
Payments	(1,540,060)	(1,533,358)	(1,587,568)	(1,676,797)	(1,773,913)	(1,954,654)	(2,044,649)	(2,096,458)	(2,192,671)	(2,298,788)
Net cash inflow/(outflow) from operating activities	**541,888**	**627,639**	**682,678**	**708,196**	**719,789**	**643,922**	**711,874**	**921,324**	**971,123**	**986,345**
CASH FLOWS FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES										
Proceeds from sale of property, plant and equipment	22,936	5,313	11,101	13,771	11,921	10,139	15,220	8,968	9,649	9,649
Payments for property, plant and equipment	(1,069,391)	(921,455)	(997,841)	(877,985)	(1,143,026)	(869,619)	(854,703)	(943,480)	(987,174)	(920,003)
Net cash inflow/(outflow) from investing activities	**(1,046,455)**	**(916,142)**	**(986,740)**	**(864,214)**	**(1,131,105)**	**(859,480)**	**(839,483)**	**(934,512)**	**(977,525)**	**(910,354)**
CASH FLOWS FROM FINANCING ACTIVITIES										
Proceeds from borrowings	353,368	168,265	340,781	310,885	527,911	357,428	237,920	125,520	140,998	144,565
Repayment of borrowings	(64,843)	(65,553)	(72,477)	(86,490)	(91,652)	(93,174)	(106,707)	(113,816)	(122,917)	(132,004)
Net cash inflow/(outflow) from financing activities	**288,525**	**102,712**	**268,303**	**224,395**	**436,259**	**264,255**	**131,213**	**11,704**	**18,081**	**12,561**
NET INCREASE/(DECREASE) IN CASH HELD	(216,041)	(185,791)	(35,759)	68,376	24,943	48,697	3,604	(1,484)	11,679	88,552
Cash at beginning of financial year	710,000	493,959	308,168	272,409	340,785	365,729	414,425	418,030	416,545	428,225
Closing Cash & Deposits Balance	**493,959**	**308,168**	**272,409**	**340,785**	**365,729**	**414,425**	**418,030**	**416,545**	**428,225**	**516,777**

2.10 Statement of Changes in Equity 2025-26 to 2034-35

		Retained Capital ($'000)	Capital and Operating Reserves ($'000)	Asset revaluation Reserve ($'000)	Total Community Equity ($'000)
2025-26 Initial Budget	Balance at beginning of year	10,514,296	660,715	10,296,937	21,471,948
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	220,204	-	-	220,204
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	203,662	(203,662)	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**10,938,161**	**457,053**	**10,296,937**	**21,692,151**
2026-27 Forecast	Balance at beginning of year	10,938,161	457,053	10,296,937	21,692,151
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	300,217	-	591,024	891,241
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	162,281	(162,281)	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**11,400,659**	**294,773**	**10,887,961**	**22,583,392**
2027-28 Forecast	Balance at beginning of year	11,400,659	294,773	10,887,961	22,583,392
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	335,571	-	30,325	365,896
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	22,265	(22,265)	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**11,758,495**	**272,508**	**10,918,286**	**22,949,288**
2028-29 Forecast	Balance at beginning of year	11,758,495	272,508	10,918,286	22,949,288
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	343,994	-	35,405	379,399
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	(78,026)	78,026	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**12,024,462**	**350,534**	**10,953,691**	**23,328,687**
2029-30 Forecast	Balance at beginning of year	12,024,462	350,534	10,953,691	23,328,687
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	340,810	-	40,790	381,600
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	(33,350)	33,350	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**12,331,923**	**383,883**	**10,994,481**	**23,710,287**
2030-31 Forecast	Balance at beginning of year	12,331,923	383,883	10,994,481	23,710,287
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	230,867	-	43,600	274,467
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	(46,434)	46,434	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**12,516,356**	**430,317**	**11,038,081**	**23,984,754**
2031-32 Forecast	Balance at beginning of year	12,516,356	430,317	11,038,081	23,984,754
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	311,929	-	28,815	340,744
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	(23,567)	23,567	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**12,804,718**	**453,884**	**11,066,896**	**24,325,498**
2032-33 Forecast	Balance at beginning of year	12,804,718	453,884	11,066,896	24,325,498
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	521,367	-	27,200	548,567
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	(39,343)	39,343	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**13,286,743**	**493,227**	**11,094,096**	**24,874,065**
2033-34 Forecast	Balance at beginning of year	13,286,743	493,227	11,094,096	24,874,065
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	523,879	-	24,775	548,654
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	(20,101)	20,101	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**13,790,521**	**513,327**	**11,118,871**	**25,422,719**
2034-35 Forecast	Balance at beginning of year	13,790,521	513,327	11,118,871	25,422,719
	Change in net assets resulting from operations	524,691	-	24,077	548,768
	Transfer to / (from) reserves	(96,532)	96,532	-	-
	Balance at end of the year	**14,218,680**	**609,859**	**11,142,948**	**25,971,487**

2.11 Detailed rates and charges

The City sets its rates and charges on the following principles which are set out in the City's Revenue Policy:

a. Equity and fairness - ensuring the fair and consistent levying of rates and charges, without bias, taking into account all relevant considerations.
b. Equity for like properties - ensuring similarly valued land, used for the same or similar purposes, and receive similar services are levied similar general rates.
c. User pays - where appropriate, levying rates and charges on the specific users of services or facilities to assist in alleviating the costs associated with the provision of the service or facility on the general community.
d. Meaningful contribution - recognising that not all properties utilise or rely on Council services equally and adopting a differential rating system to ensure that all properties provide a meaningful contribution to the costs of Council providing services or facilities.
e. Predictability - ensuring rates and charges are set and applied in a generally consistent manner and any significant increases in rates and charges are reasonable and transparent.

Section 169 (6) of the Regulation requires the following disclosure regarding the total increase in rates and utility revenue year on year within the City's annual budget.

Table 5: Total rates and charges comparison 2024-25 to 2025-26

Rate Category	2024-25 Initial Budget ($'000)	Rate Increase / (Decrease) ($'000)	Rate Increase / (Decrease) %	Growth Increase / (Decrease) ($'000)	Growth Increase / (Decrease) %	2025-26 Proposed Budget ($'000)	Total Increase / (Decrease) %
General Rates and Utility Charges							
General Rates (Gross)	805,804	20,306	2.52%	5,192	0.64%	831,302	3.16%
Sewerage	244,673	12,100	4.95%	2,042	0.83%	258,816	5.78%
Drinking Water (excluding bulk water)	173,603	10,005	5.76%	2,284	1.32%	185,892	7.08%
Waste Management Utility Charge	124,099	30,345	24.45%	1,423	1.15%	155,867	25.60%
Non Drinking Water	1,433	92	6.42%	490	34.19%	2,015	40.61%
Sub -Total	**1,349,612**	**72,848**	**5.40%**	**11,431**	**0.85%**	**1,433,892**	**6.24%**
Separate Charges							
City Transport Improvement Separate Charge	59,640	5,776	9.68%	1,008	1.69%	66,424	11.37%
Recreational Space Separate Charge	8,577	193	2.25%	149	1.74%	8,919	3.99%
Open Space including Koala Habitat, Maintenance & Environment Separate Charge	17,324	568	3.28%	302	1.74%	18,194	5.02%
Volunteer Fire Brigade Separate Charge	568	0	0.00%	10	1.76%	578	1.76%
Disaster Management Response and Recovery Separate Charge	0	2,880	100.00%	0	0.00%	2,880	100.00%
Sub -Total	**86,109**	**9,417**	**10.94%**	**1,469**	**1.71%**	**96,995**	**12.64%**
Total General Rates, Utility Charges and Separate Rates	**1,435,721**	**82,265**	**5.73%**	**12,900**	**0.90%**	**1,530,887**	**6.63%**
Special Rates							
Centre Improvement Program Special Rate	73	(73)	(100.00%)	0	0.00%	0	(100.00%)
Sub -Total	**73**	**(73)**	**(100.00%)**	**0**	**0.00%**	**0**	**(100.00%)**
Total Council Rates and Charges	**1,435,794**	**82,192**	**5.72%**	**12,900**	**0.90%**	**1,530,887**	**6.62%**
State Government Charges Outside Council Control							
Bulk Water 'Pass through' Revenue (State Government)	198,927	4,217	2.12%	3,601	1.81%	206,745	3.93%
Sub -Total	**198,927**	**4,217**	**2.12%**	**3,601**	**1.81%**	**206,745**	**3.93%**
Total Rates and Charges	**1,634,721**	**86,409**	**5.29%**	**16,501**	**1.01%**	**1,737,632**	**6.30%**

Note 1 - Excludes internal rates and charges.

Note 2 - Section 169 (7) of the Regulation precludes the inclusion of the following:

- 10% discount on the general rate for payment of rates by due date
- rate concessions for approximately 30,000 eligible pensioners.

Note 3 - The comparison of Rates and Charges (Gross) shows the increase in total rates for all properties across the City. The City uses a differential general rating system and therefore the increases applicable to different types of properties, with different valuations, and in different general rating categories will vary from each other, and the overall increases shown above.

2.12 Statement of Reserves 2025-26

This section lists the purpose of each of the City's reserves and the reserve movements contained in the 2025-26 budget including the estimated opening and closing balances and the transfers to or from each reserve as contained in the budget.

Reserve movements in 2025-26

The following table details the opening and closing reserve balances for the financial year 2025-26 with the associated transfers to and from reserves being contained within the City's initial adopted budget for the financial year.

City of Gold Coast: proposed reserves 2025-26

Reserve	Budgeted Opening Bal 1-7-2025 ($'000)	Transfers In ($'000)	Transfers Out ($'000)	Budgeted Closing Bal 30-6-2026 ($'000)
Capital Projects Reserves				
City Place Making Reserve	6,656	-	(3,471)	3,185
City Transport Improvement Reserve	944	66,424	(66,424)	944
Cultural Precinct Reserve	2,005	-	-	2,005
Infrastructure Charges Reimbursement Reserve	520	-	-	520
Koala Habitat Acquisition and Enhancement Reserve	5,167	1,444	-	6,611
Open Space Reserve	1,656	16,813	(16,348)	2,122
Parks & Recreation Reserve	3,376	8,919	(3,154)	9,141
Roadworks Acquisition Reserve	95	-	-	95
Strategic Priorities Reserve	29,529	-	(2,028)	27,501
Tourist Park Reserve	8,696	4,204	(10,048)	2,852
Waste Management Reserve	42,442	18,420	(10,717)	50,145
Waste Recycling Utility Charge Reserve	9,531	3,466	(11,893)	1,104
Water and Sewerage Infrastructure Reserve	123,001	-	(31,971)	91,029
Total Capital Reserves	**233,617**	**119,690**	**(156,053)**	**197,254**
Operating Reserves				
Coomera River Dredging Contribution Reserve	3,949	178	-	4,127
Events Reserve	1,401	1,000	(700)	1,701
Hope Island Channel Reserve	4,507	620	-	5,127
Total Operating Reserves	**9,857**	**1,798**	**(700)**	**10,955**
Self Insurance Reserves				
Insurance Liability Reserve	219	-	-	219
Workers Compensation Reserve	16,512	1,143	-	17,655
Total Insurance Reserves	**16,731**	**1,143**	**-**	**17,874**
Investment Fund Reserves				
Gold Coast Investment Fund Reserve	9,397	26,622	(22,000)	14,019
Economic Investment Reserve	4,263	2,240	(2,473)	4,030
Total Investment Fund Reserves	**13,660**	**28,862**	**(24,473)**	**18,049**
Total Capital & Operating Reserves	**273,866**	**151,493**	**(181,226)**	**244,132**

Strategic Priorities Reserve details

Strategic Priorities Reserve Funds Allocated to Projects	Budgeted Opening Bal 1-7-2025 ($'000)	Transfers In ($'000)	Transfers Out ($'000)	Budgeted Closing Bal 30-6-2026 ($'000)
Coomera Hub	505	-	-	505
Dive Site Tourist Attraction	495	-	-	495
Future Tourism & Economic Diversification Purposes	3,381	-	-	3,381
Gold Coast Major Events Investment Fund	1,350	-	-	1,350
GCHKP Investment Attraction Fund	3,900	-	-	3,900
MEGC - Economic and social infrastructure opportunity	500	-	-	500
Investment Atttraction Fund	4,750			4,750
Surplus from End of Year and Budget Reviews to be allocated by Council for issues deemed appropriate	2	-	-	2
Light Rail Stage 3A	625	-	-	625
HOTA Exhibitions or significant capital projects	3,923	-	-	3,923
Future Allocations (Sale of Land to St Stephens College $246,400 /yr for 5 Years $1,232,000 commencing Aug 2020)	1,232	-	-	1,232
Cableway	514	-	-	514
Environmental Offsets	5,291	-	(2,028)	3,263
Sale of Property (Lake Orr Drive, Laguna Park)	245	-	-	245
Sale of Property (Tugun Depot)	816	-	-	816
Gold Coast Civic Music Hall	2,000	-	-	2,000
Total	**29,529**	**-**	**(2,028)**	**27,501**

Infrastructure Charges Reserve

Reserves are held for infrastructure charges which are constrained by development conditions. Revenue from infrastructure charges fluctuates considerably and the figures provided below are estimates only.

Infrastructure Charges Reserve (forecast balances)	Budgeted Opening Bal 1-7-2025 ($'000)	Transfers In ($'000)	Transfers Out ($'000)	Budgeted Closing Bal 30-6-2026 ($'000)
Infrastructure Charges Reserve - Water / Sewerage	161,366	41,000	(123,124)	79,242
Infrastructure Charges Reserve - Other Council	158,463	62,500	(154,305)	66,658
Total Infrastructure Charges Reserve	**319,829**	**103,500**	**(277,429)**	**145,900**

Purpose of reserves

The City maintains a number of reserves, allowing the City to manage future commitments as part of its integrated financial management processes. The purpose of the City's reserves is listed below.

Capital projects reserves	
City Placemaking Reserve	Provision for the capital costs, current and future renewal of completed City Improvement Projects (CIP) throughout the city.
City Transport Improvement Reserve	Provision to address the City's transport infrastructure and public transport needs and advance negotiations with the State Government to gain additional funding for initiatives under the banner of the City Transport Plan.
Cultural Precinct Reserve	For the purpose of establishment, maintenance and operation of the Gold Coast Cultural Precinct.
Infrastructure Charges Reimbursement Reserve	This reserve is used to hold alternate funding sources for the delivery of trunk infrastructure. This reserve will then be used to offset the trunk infrastructure reimbursements to developers.
Koala Habitat Acquisition and Enhancement Reserve	Provision for the acquisition and enhancement of land for the preservation of koala habitat within the city, including all ancillary costs in relation to the land acquisition.
Open Space Reserve	Provision for the acquisition of land and non-acquisition purposes directly relevant to open space preservation, access and nature conservation.
Parks and Recreation Reserve	Provision for the acquisition of property and non-acquisition purposes directly relevant to recreation, including improvements to school lands where those improvements enable community use of school sports facilities.
Roadworks Acquisition Reserve	Provision for compensation payments to dispossessed landowners as a result of land acquisition for Roadworks.
Strategic Priorities Reserve	Provision for the future funding of priority projects associated with Strategic Priorities as defined in the City's Council Plan.
Tourist Park Reserve	Provision for the future funding of assets comprising the City's tourist parks.
Waste Management Reserve	Provision for the future funding of assets comprising the City's waste management.
Waste Recycling Utility Charge Reserve	Provision for the future funding of waste recycling infrastructure and renewal.
Water and Sewerage Infrastructure Reserve	Provision for the future funding of water and sewerage infrastructure and renewal.

Operating reserves	
Coomera River Dredging Contribution Reserve	To provide funding for dredging maintenance in the Coomera River for flood mitigation purposes.
Events Reserve	For the purpose of acquiring and funding events.
Hope Island Channel Reserve	Provision for the future funding of the operation and maintenance of the Hope Island Channel for flood mitigation purposes.

Self-insurance reserves	
Insurance Liability Reserve	Provides for insurance claim liabilities prior to establishment of Gold Coast City Council Insurance Co Ltd (GCCCICL) and provides for Captive Insurance claim liabilities for Motor Vehicle, Public Liability, Property, Contractor, Councillor and Officers and Professional Indemnity insurances in accordance with retention (excess) arrangements negotiated with GCCCICL.
Workers Compensation Reserve	In accordance with its self-insurance licence, the City is required to maintain a reserve fund representing the estimated claims liability as at 30 June each year based on the annual Actuarial Report.

Investment Fund reserves	
Gold Coast Investment Fund Reserve	Maximise investment opportunities for the City.
Economic Investment Reserve	To support economic investment in the city, funded by dividends from the City's optical fibre investment.

Infrastructure Charges Reserve	
Infrastructure Charges Reserve	Holds contributions made by developers for the provision of drainage, roadworks, parks, bikeways, street lighting, water, sewerage and other infrastructure assets for the enhancement of the City’s asset base.

2.13 Programs and Services

The program and service summaries on the following pages outline:

- what the programs and associated services deliver to the city
- an overview of program and service budget information
- a description of each of the services.

The services structure has been updated from the previous year to reflect recent organisational structure change and the strategic realignment of services to the Council Plan 2022-2027.

Program 1: City Planning

Deliver a liveable and sustainable city by implementing a strategic approach to long term planning.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
City Planning	11,609,010	26,247,680	0	**37,856,690**	41.7%
Development Application Assessment and Support	28,809,910	0	0	**28,809,910**	31.7%
City Design	10,406,910	5,530,871	83,814	**16,021,595**	17.6%
Development Compliance	7,823,890	0	0	**7,823,890**	8.6%
Building Certification and Information	400,530	0	0	**400,530**	0.4%
Total	**59,050,250**	**31,778,551**	**83,814**	**90,912,615**	**100.0%**

City Planning program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
City Planning	**37,856,690**
Service Description: Provide specialist land use and infrastructure planning and policy for the City through localised planning instruments including the Planning Scheme and Local Government Infrastructure Plan in compliance with Legislative requirements.	
Development Application Assessment and Support	**28,809,910**
Service Description: Support customers through the development application process, and manage the assessment of applications including infrastructure charges, developer contributions, development compliance, advice, appeals & certifications.	
City Design	**16,021,595**
Service Description: Provide specialist urban design, placemaking and architectural advice, policy development, education, assessment and advocacy services for the City.	
Development Compliance	**7,823,890**
Service Description: Manage investigations into unlawful building work / land uses and endeavour to ensure development complies with relevant legislation, development approvals and the Planning Scheme. Plumbing and Drainage activities include the provision of information, advice and assessment of applications for compliance assessable plumbing work, undertaking audits of notifiable plumbing works, on site-treatment plants and backflow prevention devices as well as maintaining records and undertaking searches to provide information relating to property specific plumbing information for the City.	
Building Certification and Information	**400,530**
Service Description: Provide building certification services, advice, information and approvals for the community, including reviewing building regulations and safety standards, searches relating to building approval documentation, whilst ensuring relevant legislative requirements are met.	

Program 2: City Transport

Connect the community by providing a reliable, safe and efficient transport network, now and for the future.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
Transport	74,712,277	301,493,967	30,333,865	**406,540,109**	100.0%
Total	**74,712,277**	**301,493,967**	**30,333,865**	**406,540,109**	**100.0%**

City Transport program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Transport	**406,540,109**

Service Description:

Plan, operate and manage the City's transport.

Program 3: Community Health and Safety

Enhance our vibrant lifestyle by protecting and strengthening the health, safety and amenity of the community.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
Disaster and Emergency Management	29,456,420	9,860,024	0	**39,316,444**	24.1%
Stormwater	9,261,390	24,772,658	0	**34,034,048**	20.9%
Local Law Enforcement	23,348,750	0	0	**23,348,750**	14.3%
Lifeguards	17,780,193	390,207	0	**18,170,400**	11.2%
Community Safety	11,591,160	1,779,812	0	**13,370,972**	8.2%
City Cleaning	10,327,856	0	0	**10,327,856**	6.3%
Public Space Activation	7,978,390	0	0	**7,978,390**	4.9%
Public and Environmental Health	7,118,000	44,763	0	**7,162,763**	4.4%
Animal Management	5,266,833	203,470	0	**5,470,303**	3.4%
Cemetery	1,888,029	552,300	0	**2,440,329**	1.5%
Flood Mitigation	1,329,872	0	0	**1,329,872**	0.8%
Total	**125,346,893**	**37,603,236**	**0**	**162,950,129**	**100.0%**

Community Health and Safety program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Disaster and Emergency Management	**39,316,444**
Service Description: Deliver effective disaster management arrangements to enable the City to mitigate, prevent, prepare for, respond to and recover from disaster events.	
Stormwater	**34,034,048**
Service Description: Manage the City's stormwater infrastructure to drain rainwater away to prevent flooding in built-up areas.	
Local Law Enforcement	**23,348,750**
Service Description: Manage approval and regulation across a diverse range of the City's Local Laws to protect the safety and amenity of residents and visitors across the city.	
Lifeguards	**18,170,400**
Service Description: Provide beach patrols, beach surveillance towers, water safety education and awareness, beach closure information and safety flags and signs to enhance the safety and enjoyment of people using the city's beaches and pools.	

Community Health and Safety program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Community Safety	**13,370,972**
Service Description: Deliver Community Safety programs and services within the City Administration, including the Safety Camera Network, educating the community on safety practices, delivering safe spaces and utilising partnerships to ensure a safe city for residents and visitors.	
City Cleaning	**10,327,856**
Service Description: Provide public cleaning to ensure all public amenities are safe and hygienic for public use.	
Public Space Activation	**7,978,390**
Service Description: Provide public space permits for individuals and community organisations to conduct selected activities including markets, commercial fitness, filming and photography, programs, and organised sport, aquatic and recreational initiatives within our parks and facilities to support an active and healthy lifestyle.	
Public and Environmental Health	**7,162,763**
Service Description: Deliver environmental health services to businesses and the general community including license approvals, education, compliance monitoring and enforcement. Services offered relate to the administration and enforcement of several sections of state legislation and local laws.	
Animal Management	**5,470,303**
Service Description: Deliver animal management initiatives to residents including registration, patrols and enforcement, impounding and off leash facilities, pet education, and complaints management, to ensure animals are appropriately cared for and managed in compliance with legislation.	
Cemetery	**2,440,329**
Service Description: Administer Council cemetery burial rights, information and commercial use to residents and businesses that meets the needs of the community.	
Flood Mitigation	**1,329,872**
Service Description: Manage the city's flood mitigation infrastructure to reduce the impacts of flooding on the community.	

Program 4: Conservation and Environment

Preserve our naturally unique city by promoting environmental sustainability and climate resilience.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
Natural Area Conservation	14,691,408	15,152,217	1,492,163	**31,335,788**	32.9%
Beaches and Waterways	16,255,003	13,187,330	0	**29,442,333**	31.0%
Environmental Conservation	10,752,064	11,801,283	0	**22,553,347**	23.7%
Vector, Urban Pest and Biosecurity	7,757,141	18,719	0	**7,775,860**	8.2%
Catchment Management	1,796,617	1,071,394	0	**2,868,011**	3.0%
Climate Resilience	854,637	0	0	**854,637**	0.9%
Environmental Improvement and Compliance	268,615	0	0	**268,615**	0.3%
Total	**52,375,485**	**41,230,943**	**1,492,163**	**95,098,591**	**100.0%**

Conservation and Environment program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Natural Area Conservation	**31,335,788**
Service Description: Manage and conserve the City's natural areas so they continue to further enhance our Gold Coast way of life both now and for future generations.	
Beaches and Waterways	**29,442,333**
Service Description: Provide clean, healthy and accessible beaches and waterways for the community, including protecting the Gold Coast from coastal hazards and environmental impacts.	
Environmental Conservation	**22,553,347**
Service Description: Provide natural environment strategic policy and planning advice, and coordinate Council's activities to protect our natural environment and recognise its significant value to our economy and lifestyle. Provide residents with free native trees and shrubs every year to enhance property greenery.	
Vector, Urban Pest and Biosecurity	**7,775,860**
Service Description: Manage pests by treating Council-managed land to reduce risks to the community and environment from cockroaches, ants, fire-ants, flies, wasps, bees, rodents, termites, biting midge, Ibis, aggressive native birds, snakes etc. and reduce the risk to public health. Manage mosquito populations in our regions through regular surveillance of mosquitoes and midges and scheduled spraying programs. In partnership with stakeholders, manage Prohibited and Restricted Invasive Biosecurity matter to protect residents, visitors and our natural environment, and to meet our statutory obligations as defined in the Biosecurity Act 2014.	

Conservation and Environment program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Catchment Management	**2,868,011**
Service Description: We monitor the health of our waterways and catchments, drive improvement initiatives and promote integrated catchment management principles through partnerships and best practice science.	
Climate Resilience	**854,637**
Service Description: Maintaining and improving the City's resilience and managing community risk exposure arising from climate change. Managing the City's energy policy through definition and implementation of policies regarding the City's energy management and supply, including GRID management and renewable sources for council facilities.	
Environmental Improvement and Compliance	**268,615**
Service Description: Provide advisory and technical services related to environmental science, legislation, and management measures through the full project lifecycle. To support the City in achieving environmental improvement and statutory compliance and to drive improvement in environmental performance.	

Program 5: Culture and Community

Celebrate and support our vibrant lifestyle through cultural diversity, activities and events.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
Community Library	25,529,749	7,928,378	0	**33,458,127**	34.7%
Community Centre Management	29,370,462	3,498,877	0	**32,869,339**	34.2%
Community Grant	9,514,780	7,010,841	0	**16,525,621**	17.2%
Community Events	6,364,160	0	0	**6,364,160**	6.6%
Community Group Support	2,731,910	0	0	**2,731,910**	2.8%
Cultural Heritage and First Nations Engagement	2,169,420	0	0	**2,169,420**	2.3%
Arts and Cultural Development	2,084,308	0	0	**2,084,308**	2.2%
Total	**77,764,789**	**18,438,096**	**0**	**96,202,885**	**100.0%**

Culture and Community program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Community Library	**33,458,127**
Service Description: Provision of library services that meet the recreational, educational, social, information and employment-related needs of the community. Services are delivered through 12 libraries, a mobile library, home library service, an outreach service, library kiosks and online for library customers to connect, learn and grow.	
Community Centre Management	**32,869,339**
Service Description: Provide and manage affordable and accessible community spaces and facilities for residents, businesses and community groups to hire and engage in the delivery of services, programs, activities and events to improve social, educational, recreational and cultural outcomes within the city.	
Community Grant	**16,525,621**
Service Description: Deliver funding programs to support community organisations to meet changing community, social, environmental, and economic objectives.	
Community Events	**6,364,160**
Service Description: Manage the City's events portfolio, including major and community events, to bring economic benefits and ensure a vibrant lifestyle.	

Culture and Community program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Community Group Support	**2,731,910**
Service Description: Deliver social planning, strategy and social development projects and programs to the community to improve social outcomes, community wellbeing and participation. Provide support and information to residents and local not-for-profit groups regarding community groups, services and facilities.	
Cultural Heritage and First Nations Engagement	**2,169,420**
Service Description: Provide historic and First Nation's cultural heritage advisory, education and advocacy to Council, residents and stakeholders, including the support of cultural events, conservation and protection of cultural heritage sites, translating and language assistance, and anti-discrimination for multicultural residents to ensure Council's statutory obligations and effective community support. Deliver and support programs, spaces, and places for our arts community to foster traditional and contemporary First Nations arts and culture.	
Arts and Cultural Development	**2,084,308**
Service Description: Deliver programs, funding, advisory, and facilities for our arts community, residents and visitors that foster diverse arts and cultural experiences and product delivery. This includes investing in skills development for our creative workforce.	

Program 6: Economic Development

Create a thriving economy through partnerships with controlled entities and management of tourist parks.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
Controlled and Funded Entities	86,748,650	0	0	**86,748,650**	66.8%
Tourist Parks and Campgrounds	18,926,087	8,201,891	982,280	**28,110,258**	21.6%
Commercial Fibre Network	7,549,081	558,730	0	**8,107,811**	6.2%
Investment Facilitation and Partnerships	3,767,200	0	0	**3,767,200**	2.9%
2032 Olympic and Paralympic Games	2,442,340	0	0	**2,442,340**	1.9%
Commercial Transactions	0	813,882	0	**813,882**	0.6%
Total	**119,433,358**	**9,574,503**	**982,280**	**129,990,141**	**100.0%**

Economic Development program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Controlled and Funded Entities	**86,748,650**
Service Description: Investment in a suite of not-for-profit entities that deliver outcomes that align with Council's strategic intent.	
Tourist Parks and Campgrounds	**28,110,258**
Service Description: Manage and operate Council's Tourist Parks and Campgrounds to provide users with a memorable holiday experience and affordable options for local, national and international guests.	
Commercial Fibre Network	**8,107,811**
Service Description: Provide a fast fibre optic network enabling WAN network and public Wi-Fi services to the city including corporate and community services, as well as provide commercial wholesale to other telco's.	
Investment Facilitation and Partnerships	**3,767,200**
Service Description: Specialist service that liaise with Government state representatives, prepares advocacy plans, and works with government to get funding for the city. Manage the Investment Attraction Program to actively target and attract key industries, employers, investment, tourism and infrastructure investment to the city, enhancing the city's economy. Advising and supporting key industries, and local workforce to encourage and promote investment on the Gold Coast.	
2032 Olympic and Paralympic Games	**2,442,340**
Service Description: Maximise opportunities for the city as a result of the 2032 Olympic and Paralympic Games. This includes planning city operations during the 2032 Olympic and Paralympic Games and delivering a range of economic, social and environmental benefits for the community.	
Commercial Transactions	**813,882**
Service Description: Planning, management and execution of commercial transactions for the City.	

Program 7: Enabling Services

Enable the City to achieve its vision by supporting the delivery of value for money community and customer services.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
Property, Workplace Facilities and Fleet	31,792,530	86,208,686	0	**118,001,216**	24.1%
Technology	84,384,274	3,921,210	0	**88,305,484**	18.0%
People	59,909,237	0	0	**59,909,237**	12.2%
Finance	13,791,199	0	44,271,158	**58,062,357**	11.8%
Customer and Channels	29,776,963	0	0	**29,776,963**	6.1%
Business Support	25,437,321	0	0	**25,437,321**	5.2%
Strategy, Performance and Transformation	24,174,974	0	0	**24,174,974**	4.9%
Risk and Audit	23,205,946	0	0	**23,205,946**	4.7%
Revenue	16,039,778	0	0	**16,039,778**	3.3%
Council and Office of the CEO	13,251,479	0	0	**13,251,479**	2.7%
Legal	11,809,450	0	0	**11,809,450**	2.4%
Work Health and Safety	11,567,820	0	0	**11,567,820**	2.4%
Strategic Asset Management	7,888,305	3,124,769	0	**11,013,074**	2.2%
Total	**353,029,276**	**93,254,664**	**44,271,158**	**490,555,098**	**100.0%**

Enabling Services program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Property, Workplace Facilities and Fleet	**118,001,216**
Service Description: Manage Council property, workplace facilities and fleet to enable safe and efficient service delivery through effective operations, maintenance, and asset planning.	
Technology	**88,305,484**
Service Description: Provide and maintain technology systems to ensure efficient operations.	
People	**59,909,237**
Service Description: Deliver workforce services including payroll and manage employee relations to build a high performing and engaged workforce while ensuring compliance with employee legal and ethical standards.	
Finance	**58,062,357**
Service Description: Provide finance, asset accounting, and procurement services to support the City's long-term financial sustainability, compliance and value for money.	

Enabling Services program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Customer and Channels	**29,776,963**
Service Description: Deliver external marketing, engagement and communication through channels that enhance the customer experience.	
Business Support	**25,437,321**
Service Description: Deliver effective business and administrative support to enable service delivery.	
Strategy, Performance and Transformation	**24,174,974**
Service Description: Transform the organisation through effective decision making, strategy, planning, portfolio and project delivery, data analysis and performance reporting.	
Risk and Audit	**23,205,946**
Service Description: Provide risk and assurance services to ensure City compliance with regulatory requirements and administer the City's insurance cover.	
Revenue	**16,039,778**
Service Description: Manage revenue services including rates, fees and charges to fund service delivery that meets community need and deliver debt recovery and hardship assistance in accordance with legislation and council policy.	
Council and Office of the CEO	**13,251,479**
Service Description: Deliver effective Council governance and support for Councillors and Council meetings and manage the requirements of the Office of the CEO.	
Legal	**11,809,450**
Service Description: Provide legal advice and support to ensure compliance and legal protection for the City.	
Work Health and Safety	**11,567,820**
Service Description: Monitor and enhance work health and safety practices to ensure compliance and conduct health monitoring for identified occupational risks.	
Strategic Asset Management	**11,013,074**
Service Description: Ensure strategic direction for asset management to maximise asset value and enable the sustainable delivery of services to the community.	

Program 8: Parks and Recreation

Manage public parks and recreation facilities to support our vibrant lifestyle.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
Community Parks	67,135,066	77,761,037	4,799,035	**149,695,138**	63.4%
Community Sport and Recreation	27,792,602	40,004,650	0	**67,797,252**	28.7%
Community Aquatic Centre	14,423,633	4,190,310	0	**18,613,943**	7.9%
Total	**109,351,301**	**121,955,997**	**4,799,035**	**236,106,333**	**100.0%**

Parks and Recreation program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Community Parks	**149,695,138**
Service Description: Provision of parklands for the community to access, including playgrounds, green spaces, outdoor sports and recreation facilities to deliver safe, active and heathy community outcomes.	
Community Sport and Recreation	**67,797,252**
Service Description: Provide access and manage bookings of sports, major venue and recreation fields and facilities to community organisations to support community sporting and recreation.	
Community Aquatic Centre	**18,613,943**
Service Description: Provide recreational and water sporting activities to the community, including access to swimming lessons and aquatic classes to support community health and wellbeing.	

Program 9: Waste Management

Deliver waste infrastructure and provide collection, disposal and recycling of waste materials.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
Solid Waste Disposal	71,990,650	123,921,971	0	**195,912,621**	62.0%
Waste Collection	51,008,541	0	13,387,456	**64,395,997**	20.3%
Waste Recycling	24,168,186	31,344,794	0	**55,512,980**	17.5%
Public Litterbins	709,082	0	0	**709,082**	0.2%
Total	**147,876,459**	**155,266,765**	**13,387,456**	**316,530,680**	**100.0%**

Waste Management program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Solid Waste Disposal	**195,912,621**
Service Description: Provide solid waste disposal facilities to ensure waste is managed in accordance with industry standards for the city, while ensuring noncompliance activities are investigated.	
Waste Collection	**64,395,997**
Service Description: Manage waste collection services (inclusive of general waste, green organics and recyclable materials) to support the collection and recovery of essential waste services for the city.	
Waste Recycling	**55,512,980**
Service Description: Manage waste and recycling centres (inclusive of general waste, green organics and recyclable materials) and resource recovery facilities to support the collection and recovery of essential waste services for the city.	
Public Litterbins	**709,082**
Service Description: Manage the installation, maintenance and collection of City bins for the community to ensure all public conveniences are safe and hygienic for public use and in proper working order.	

Program 10: Water and Sewerage

Provide clean drinking water and the effective management of wastewater and sewerage systems.

Budget summary

Service	Operating ($)	Capital ($)	Internal Debt Service ($)	Total ($)	%
Drinking Water Distribution	298,818,721	52,655,696	7,449	**351,481,866**	53.7%
Sewage Collection and Treatment	87,435,066	205,829,020	4,984,043	**298,248,129**	45.7%
Recycled Water Distribution	1,511,362	244,164	0	**1,755,526**	0.3%
Scientific Laboratory	1,604,798	65,111	0	**1,669,909**	0.3%
Total	**389,369,947**	**258,793,990**	**4,991,492**	**653,155,429**	**100.0%**

Water and Sewerage program, by service	2025-26 Expense ($)
Drinking Water Distribution	**351,481,866**
Service Description: Manage and monitor drinking water connections, facilities and systems, including supplier relationships with the State Government, for provision of drinking water distribution to the City, businesses and the community.	
Sewage Collection and Treatment	**298,248,129**
Service Description: Manage the delivery and maintenance of sewage treatment facilities for city businesses and the community, with a commitment to minimise potential impacts to the environment and public health.	
Recycled Water Distribution	**1,755,526**
Service Description: Manage and monitor recycled water connections, facilities and systems for the provision of recycled water distribution to the City, businesses and the community.	
Scientific Laboratory	**1,669,909**
Service Description: Collect water and sewage samples and perform on-site analytical tests the City's internal and external customers, in compliance with NATA (National Association of Testing Authorities, Australia) accreditation requirements with compliance to NATA and ISO/IEC 17025 Standards. Deliver accurate, high quality Microbiological, Chemical and physical analyses of water and sewage samples to the City's internal and external customers in compliance with NATA and ISO/IEC 17025 requirements.	

2.14 Code of Competitive Conduct

Estimated activity statement

A local government's budget must, for each business activity, contain an estimated activity statement for the activities subject to the Code of Competitive Conduct (section 34 of the Regulation). Business activities covered within the statement include Building Certification Group, Gold Coast Water, Gold Coast Waste Management, Tourist Parks and Surfers Paradise Beachfront Markets.

Activities to which the Code of Competitive Conduct applies

The following activity statements are for the activities subject to the Code of Competitive Conduct:

	Waste Management Services Initial Budget ($'000)	Tourist Parks Initial Budget ($'000)	Water & Sewerage Services Initial Budget ($'000)	Building Certification Group Initial Budget ($'000)	Surfers Paradise Beachfront Markets Initial Budget ($'000)
Revenue for Services provided to the Council	4,169	0	6,045	0	0
Revenue for services provided to external clients	189,466	29,184	735,356	13	1,150
Community Service Obligations (CSOs)	3,311	1,800	0	174	0
Total Revenue	**196,946**	**30,984**	**741,401**	**187**	**1,150**
Less: Total Expenditure	**165,442**	**27,099**	**704,288**	**401**	**530**
Net Result	**31,504**	**3,885**	**37,113**	**(214)**	**620**

Activities to which the Code of Competitive Conduct has not been applied

The following activities may have some form of competition, but the code of competitive conduct has not been applied as the level of competition is low:

Activity	Reason the Code of Competitive Conduct will not be applied
Aquatic Centres	The City is providing services traditionally provided by a local government and while some private sector entities provide similar services, often on a smaller scale, there would be a gap in the supply of these services if the City did not provide them. Further, pricing for commercial services, like learn to swim and fitness centres, are benchmarked against industry prices, thus avoiding any pricing advantage from government ownership.
Community Centres	The City is providing services traditionally provided by a local government and while the private sector does provide space for hire, there would be a gap in the supply of these services if the City did not provide them. This is especially true for meeting the demand from community and non-commercial groups.
Off-street Parking	Prices are benchmarked against private sector providers so that no price advantage exists due to government ownership.
Cemeteries	The City is providing services traditionally provided by a local government. The City cemeteries are located on State land held by the City in trust for the purpose of providing cemetery services. There is one private sector competitor within the boundaries of the city. There would be a gap in the supply of these services if the City did not provide them. The private sector entity generally provides a premium service while the City concentrates on a more affordable standard level of service. Pricing for City services are set on a cost recovery basis, which does not take into account notional costs under the full-cost pricing provisions required by the code of competitive conduct. The biggest barrier for entry into the cemetery market on the Gold Coast is the cost of land in desirable locations. It is unlikely that the City's pricing practices are a deterrent to new businesses entering the market.
Large Scale Music Events (over 5,000 attendees)	All large-scale live music events staged by the City or its controlled entities have some purpose other than a commercial profit-making purpose. This may include promoting local talent, generating economic activity or attracting tourism. For this reason, events are often free or are charged below cost. Applying the code of competitive conduct will not alter pricing for events that are staged for non-commercial purposes. The revenue and costs of each event will be disaggregated and separately reported in the City's Annual Report.
Fitness Centres	The City sets prices for gym memberships by benchmarking against comparable gyms across the city, taking into account the types of services and facilities provided. Due to the high level of private sector competition, the revenue and costs for running fitness centres will be separately reported in the City's Annual Report.
Optic Fibre Network	A recent review of the Optic Fibre Network determined the main purpose is to support the provision of internal services to the City Administration and wholesale services to Gold Coast businesses via Telecommunications Carriers and Internet Service Providers. The review recommends a pricing strategy benchmarked against other providers and as such no price advantage exists due to government ownership.

2.15 Community Service Obligations (CSOs)

The CSO value is determined by the City and represents an activity's costs which would not be incurred if the activity's primary objective was to make a profit. The City provides funding from general revenue to the business activity to cover the cost of providing non-commercial community services or costs deemed to be CSOs by the City. Details of CSOs relevant to activities subject to the Code of Competitive Conduct are presented as follows:

Community service obligations - Gold Coast Water

Activity	CSO description	Amount
Water and Sewerage Rates Donation*	Concessions/discounts to non-profit entities for water and sewerage services provided in accordance with the City's Rates Donations, Infrastructure Charges and Development Application Fee Discount Policy	$ 3,334,223

** Funded by Gold Coast Water*

Community service obligations - Gold Coast Waste Management

Activity	CSO description	Amount
Bulky Waste Collection	Program of bulky kerbside waste collection for eligible dwellings within the waste collection areas.	$ 2,457,800
South Stradbroke Island Waste Disposal (Net)*	Waste management services provided to South Stradbroke Island customers	$ 998,978
Waste Collection Donation*	Concessions/discounts to non-profit entities for collection costs provided in accordance with the City's Rate Donation, Infrastructure Charges and Development Application Fee Discount Policy.	$ 808,140
Street and Park Bin Services	Disposal of solid waste from waste bins at nominated City parks, streets, boat ramps and public places.	$ 709,082
Landfill Disposal Donation*	Concessions/discounts to non-profit entities for landfill disposal costs provided to a range of approved charities and non-profit entities.	$ 520,000
Carcass Collection	Collection and disposal of dead animals from roads, reserves and foreshores	$ 123,760
Clean-up Australia Day	Provision of solid waste collection and disposal services and administrative support for Clean-up Australia Day	$ 20,000

** Funded by Gold Coast Waste Management*

Community service obligations - Building Certification Group

Activity	CSO description	Amount
Building Certification Group	Non-chargeable employee costs for time allocated to general public enquiries.	$ 174,480

Community service obligations - Tourist Parks

Activity	CSO description	Amount
Tourist Parks	Purchase of manufactured homes on permanent rental sites at Kirra Beach Tourist Park.	$ 1,800,000

2.16 Revenue Policy 2025-26

Purpose

To outline the principles that guide the development and collection of Council of the City of Gold Coast (Council) Revenue.

Section 104(5)(c)(iii) of the *Local Government Act 2009* and section 193 of the *Local Government Regulation 2012*, require this policy to set out:

a. the principles which Council will apply during the 2025-26 financial year for:
   i. levying rates and charges
   ii. granting concessions for rates and charges
   iii. the recovery of unpaid rates and charges
   iv. cost-recovery fees and methods
b. the purpose of the concessions and
c. the extent to which physical and social infrastructure costs for a new development are to be funded by charges for the development.

Scope

This policy applies to the making, levying, recovery and concessions for rates and utility charges and the setting of regulatory and commercial fees and charges for Council.

This policy applies to the financial year commencing 1 July 2025 and ending 30 June 2026.

Policy statement

Revenue raising principles

1. Council makes decisions about levying rates, fees and charges consistently with the Local Government Principles:
   a. transparent and effective processes, and decision-making in the public interest
   b. sustainable development and management of assets and infrastructure, and delivery of effective services
   c. democratic representation, social inclusion and meaningful community engagement
   d. good governance of, and by, local government and
   e. ethical and legal behaviour of councillors, local government employees and councillor advisors.

2. Council will apply these principles when:
   a. making rates and charges
   b. levying rates and charges
   c. recovering rates and charges
   d. granting and administering rates and charges concessions
   e. charging for local government services and facilities
   f. charging for business activities and facilities (subject to the National Competition Policy)
   g. imposing cost-recovery and other fees and
   h. funding Council infrastructure.

Principles used for the levying of rates and charges

3. Council applies the following principles when making and levying rates and charges as detailed in the Revenue Statement:
    a. Equity and fairness - ensuring the fair and consistent levying of rates and charges, without bias, taking account all relevant considerations.
    b. Equity for like properties - ensuring similarly valued land, used for the same or similar purposes, and receiving similar services are levied similar general rates.
    c. User pays – where appropriate, levying rates and charges on the specific users of services or facilities to assist in alleviating the costs associated with the provision of the service or facility on the general community.
    d. Meaningful contribution – recognising that not all properties utilise or rely on Council services equally and adopting a differential rating system to ensure that all properties provide a meaningful contribution to the costs of Council providing services or facilities.
    e. Predictability – ensuring rates and charges are set and applied in a generally consistent manner and any significant increases in rates and charges are reasonable and transparent.

4. In addition, when levying the rates and charges, Council will:
    a. have regard to its long-term financial forecast and asset management planning when setting rates and charges, ensuring the current and future needs of Council can be met
    b. seek to minimise the revenue required to be raised from rates and charges by–
        i. maximising income from available grants and subsidies
        ii. imposing cost-recovery fees in respect of services and activities for which it believes cost recovery is appropriate
    c. have regard to the prevailing local economic conditions and the need to encourage a strong and sustainable local economy, and when possible, limit increases to avoid significant price escalation in any one year.

5. Council may levy special rates and charges to minimise the extent to which the general community subsidises the unique costs arising from the provision of local government benefits or services to particular land.

Principles used for granting concessions for rates and charges

6. Council will support desirable community objectives by providing concessions for certain categories of ratepayers and in respect of properties used for certain purposes when those concessions:
    a. reduce the financial burden of rates and charges payable by pensioners or other identified persons, at Council's discretion
    b. support the community activities of not-for-profit organisations that encourage the economic development of all or part of the local government area or support entities that provide assistance or encouragement for arts or cultural development and
    c. encourage the preservation, restoration or maintenance of land that is of cultural, environmental, historic, heritage or scientific significance to the local government area.

7. In applying concessions Council will:
    a. endeavour to assist sectors of the ratepaying community to remain in their homes through such mechanisms as deferments
    b. acknowledge that sectors of the ratepaying community (e.g., pensioners) have a reduced capacity to pay both on demand and to the full quantum
    c. acknowledge the contribution of not-for-profit community organisations based on the level of their community assistance and economic value to the region and the community
    d. ensure similar treatment for ratepayers with similar circumstances
    e. make clear the requirements necessary to receive concessions
    f. make transparent the degree of subsidy or Community Service Obligation when a user charge does not represent full cost recovery and
    g. be sufficiently flexible to respond to local economic issues.

8. Council may provide relief against financial hardship in extreme circumstances where it considers such relief is justified and in the interests of the community. In these instances, and subject to the conditions determined by resolution of Council, rebates of rates and charges may be granted.

9. In the case of granting concessions to a class of ratepayers under section 119, 120 of the *Local Government Regulation 2012*, the purpose of the class concession will be stated. Consideration may also be given by Council to granting a class concession in the event all or part of the Council area is declared a natural disaster area by the State Government.

Purpose of concessions and rebates

10. The following table summarises the concessions and rebates of Council and their purpose.

Concessions and rebates for rates and charges	Purpose of the concessions and rebates
Concession to pensioners who meet the criteria set out in the Revenue Statement	To assist pensioners to reduce the overall burden of rates and utility charges
Concession to assist not-for-profit community organisations of the classes identified in the Assistance Policy.	To support the social benefit provided by eligible not-for-profit community organisations.
Concession to property owners who meet the criteria set out in the Assistance Policy	To assist ratepayers, who are parties to Voluntary Conservation Agreements with Council, to manage the natural value of their land parcels the subject of the agreements.
Rebates on water and sewage volumetric charges in accordance with the Concealed Water Leak Policy and the South East Queensland Customer Water and Wastewater Code	To relieve ratepayers from some of the unexpected financial burden caused by a concealed underground water leak.
Rebates on water and sewage volumetric charges in accordance with the Assistance Policy.	To relieve ratepayers from the unexpected financial burden caused by usage of water to fight a fire to protect their home or business.
Rebates on water and sewage volumetric charges in accordance with the Assistance Policy.	To relieve ratepayers who are renal dialysis patients, from the additional financial burden caused by a need to have dialysis at home.

11. Council may provide relief for the purpose of encouraging economic development in the city where it considers that providing such relief will aid economic growth. In these instances, and subject to the conditions determined by resolution of Council, rebates of rates and charges may be granted.

Principles used for recovering overdue rates and charges

12. Council will exercise its recovery powers to reduce the overall rate burden on ratepayers, guided by the following principles:
    a. making clear the obligations of ratepayers and the process used by Council in assisting them to meet their financial obligations
    b. making the processes used to recover outstanding rates and utility charges clear, simple to administer and cost effective
    c. considering the capacity to pay in determining appropriate payment plans for different sectors of the community
    d. endeavouring to treat ratepayers with similar circumstances in a consistent way
    e. flexibility to ratepayers experiencing financial hardship through concessional arrangements and
    f. flexibility responding when necessary to citywide events such as natural disasters or changes in the local economy.

Principles used for the setting of cost-recovery fees

13. Council considers that in almost all instances it is appropriate and in the community interest to apply full cost recovery to its water, sewerage, waste and recycling utility charges, which includes obtaining a return on capital for assets used in the delivery of these services. In accordance with section 97 of the *Local Government Act 2009*, cost-recovery fees will also be set for other services and activities for which Council believes it is appropriate.

14. A return on capital will only be charged where permissible under the *Local Government Act 2009* or *Local Government Regulation 2012*. By imposing charges that accurately reflect the full cost of the provision of services, the Council will promote efficiency in both provision and use of the services.

15. Council may choose to subsidise the charges from other sources (e.g., general rate revenue) when the Council believes that is in the community interest.

16. In setting cost-recovery fees Council will recover the cost of providing the service or of taking the action for which the fee is charged. Council may resolve to recover less than the full cost to it where it considers appropriate.

17. Whilst Council notes that, pursuant to section 97 of the *Local Government Act 2009* it may introduce a tax component into a regulatory fee to achieve a social or other objective, it is not Council's intention to encompass a tax in any regulatory fee. Accordingly, Council will not recover more than the cost of administering the regulatory regime.

Principles used for the funding of new development

18. To minimise the impact of physical and social infrastructure charges on the efficiency of the local economy, Council will be guided by the principle of user pays in the making of physical and social infrastructure charges for new development, to the extent permissible by law. Council may depart from applying this principle if it is determined by Council that it is in the community interest to do so.

19. Council's infrastructure charging framework has been established in accordance with the legislative requirements of the *Planning Act 2016*. Under section 113 of the *Planning Act 2016* local governments may, by resolution, adopt charges for providing trunk infrastructure for development (infrastructure charges). Schedule 16 of the *Planning Regulation 2017* states the maximum amount for each charge.

Definitions

All definitions are in accordance with the *Local Government Act 2009* and *Local Government Regulation 2012*.

Legislative references

Land Valuation Act 2010
Local Government Act 2009
Local Government Regulation 2012
Planning Act 2016
South East Queensland Customer Water and Wastewater Code
Water Act 2000

Supporting documents

Adopted Budget (including Revenue Statement 2025-26 and Resolution of Rates and Charges 2025-26)
Assistance Policy
Concealed Water Leak Policy
Long Term Financial Plan
Rate Donation, Infrastructure Charges and Development Assessment Fee Discount Policy
Waste Disposal Fee Concession Policy

2.17 Debt Policy 2025-26

Purpose

To outline parameters for borrowing and debt levels within the context of Council of the City of Gold Coast's (Council's) Long Term Financial Plan (LTFP) and annual budget.

Scope

This policy applies to any current and future borrowings (funds) which Council obtains from external sources by loans, overdraft, or other financial arrangements, that impose an obligation for repayment (debt), and working capital facilities each financial year from 1 July to 30 June.

Policy statement

Criteria for borrowings

1. Council assesses the long-term financial sustainability of all financial decisions by undertaking 10-year financial planning.

2. Council's borrowing program will be based on a sustainable financial outlook and will only be undertaken where Council can show that repayments can be met.

3. The purpose of the new borrowings is to fund capital expenditure and investment initiatives.

4. When borrowing for infrastructure, the term of the loan must not exceed the finite life of the related asset.

5. Borrowings will be undertaken in accordance with Queensland Treasury Corporation (QTC) guidelines and the *Statutory Bodies Financial Arrangements Act 1982*.

6. The estimated account balance and weighted average remaining term for Council's existing debt with QTC is outlined in the below table:

Estimated account balance 30 June 2025	Weighted average remaining term (years)
$810,355,751	15.55

7. Pursuant to section 192 of the *Local Government Regulation 2012*, Council's Debt Policy must state the following (as shown in the table further below):
    a. the new borrowings planned for the current financial year and the next nine (9) financial years and
    b. the period over which it is planned to repay existing and new borrowings.

8. Council ensures it manages its debt responsibly by ensuring budgeted and forecast borrowings remain within the agreed financial ratio target (as shown in the table below).

2025-26 to 2034-35 Borrowings Program and debt servicing capacity

City of Gold Coast Borrowings Program			Debt servicing capacity
Year	Term (years)	Amount ($)	Leverage ratio Target band 0 – 4 (times)
Initial Budget 2025-26	20	353,368,187	2.3
Forecast 2026-27	20	168,264,996	2.1
Forecast 2027-28	20	340,780,539	2.3
Forecast 2028-29	20	310,885,349	2.5
Forecast 2029-30	20	527,910,678	3.1
Forecast 2030-31	20	357,428,429	3.9
Forecast 2031-32	20	237,919,790	3.5
Forecast 2032-33	20	125,519,764	2.6
Forecast 2033-34	20	140,997,905	2.6
Forecast 2034-35	20	144,565,436	2.6

Working capital facility

9. Council maintains a working capital facility arrangement with QTC to provide a short-term line of credit for unexpected volatility in cash funds.

10. Council will review its cashflow in line with annual budgets and forecast borrowings to ensure sufficient cash (unconstrained within existing term deposits) is available for major outlays forecast for each financial year and beyond.

12. Any approved working capital limit will only be used by Council for operational liquidity management purposes with all drawdowns repaid in full within three months.

Definitions

Leverage ratio is the ability to repay existing debt.

Legislative references

Local Government Act 2009
Local Government Regulation 2012
Statutory Bodies Financial Arrangements Act 1982
Statutory Bodies Financial Arrangements Regulation 2019

Supporting documents

Adopted Budget
Department of Housing, Local Government, Planning and Public Works Financial Management (Sustainability) Guideline – Guideline 2024 version 1
Investment Policy
Long Term Financial Plan